

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 1/12: Three designed traits, one package

NEUTRALITY -> impartial service to any elected government; not the absence of policy influence

PERMANENCE -> continuity and institutional memory across changes of political government

ANONYMITY -> confidential advice; the minister answers publicly for the policy outcome

RULE -> the three were designed together; weakening one destabilises the other two

MUST REMEMBER: Civil services provide continuity, expertise, coordination, implementation...

ASCC MASTER FLOW – PANEL 2/12: Neutrality: what it is and what it is not

IS -> impartial implementation of lawful policy irrespective of personal preference

IS -> the reason the same officer can serve successive, ideologically different governments

IS NOT -> silence, passivity or the absence of technical and expert policy advice

IS NOT -> loyalty to the government of the day rather than to the Constitution

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 3/12: Constitutional setting card

ARTICLES 309 TO 311 -> recruitment, service conditions, pleasure doctrine, dismissal safeguards

ARTICLE 312 -> Parliament may create an All India Service after the Rajya Sabha resolution

GOVERNANCE USE -> tenure protection is the legal basis on which neutrality rests

BOUNDARY -> commission composition, appointment and removal detail is Polity-owned

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 4/12: Three layers of civil-service legitimacy

STRUCTURAL -> neutrality, permanence and anonymity built into the design

PROCEDURAL -> conduct rules, vigilance machinery, disciplinary process, appraisal

PERCEPTUAL -> sustained public belief that unelected discretion is exercised impartially

CLAIM -> the first two can be formally sound while the third erodes independently

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 5/12: Six pillars of the capacity programme

- 1 POLICY FRAMEWORK -> the reform intent and its stated shift to role-based learning
- 2 INSTITUTIONAL FRAMEWORK -> including the Capacity Building Commission
- 3 COMPETENCY FRAMEWORK -> behavioural, functional and domain competencies mapped to roles
- 4 DIGITAL LEARNING FRAMEWORK -> the online platform that delivers modules at scale
- 5 ELECTRONIC HUMAN-RESOURCE MANAGEMENT -> the personnel data spine of the reform
- 6 MONITORING AND EVALUATION -> the pillar on which the verdict must ultimately rest

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 6/12: Institutional chain in four tiers

APEX GUIDANCE -> Prime Minister's Human Resources Council

COORDINATION -> Cabinet Secretariat Coordination Unit

STANDARDS AND PLANS -> Capacity Building Commission, Annual Capacity Building Plans

PLATFORM OPERATION -> Karmayogi Bharat, the government-owned special purpose vehicle

TRAP -> the Commission sets standards; it does not operate the platform

CLOSE DISTINCTION: Political neutrality is not constitutional value-neutrality, anonymity...

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 7/12: Dated capacity anchors

CABINET APPROVAL -> 2 September 2020, Ministry of Personnel, Public Grievances and Pensions

COMMISSION ESTABLISHED -> 1 April 2021, stated on the Commission's official website

OFFICIAL PAGE READ -> 2 September 2026; repository status re-verified 13 August 2026

INSTRUMENTS -> Annual Capacity Building Plans and the Karmayogi Competency Model

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 8/12: Output against outcome

OUTPUT -> enrolment, course counts, completions, certificates on a live dashboard

OUTCOME -> competency-to-post fit and trained behaviour visible in work products

OUTCOME -> service timelines, grievance recurrence, appeal outcomes, tenure stability

DISCIPLINE -> no platform total is asserted anywhere; the number changes daily

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 9/12: Generalist, specialist and lateral entry

GENERALIST -> breadth for coordination across sectors and levels of government

SPECIALIST -> depth for technology, finance and climate policy complexity

LATERAL ENTRY -> bounded, periodic recruitment at Joint Secretary, Director, Deputy Secretary

LIMIT -> shorter contractual tenure and weaker socialisation into permanent-service norms

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 10/12: How neutrality erodes

UNCONSTRAINED POSTING AND TRANSFER DISCRETION

- > officers anticipate the political executive's preference before advice is asked for
- > permanence protects the office, not the post: displacement is easier than dismissal
- > anonymity turns asymmetric: public blame in controversy, invisibility in achievement
- > perceived partiality erodes the legitimacy of unelected discretionary power

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 11/12: Reform conflict ladder

FIXED MINIMUM TENURE -> repairs arbitrary transfer; can entrench a poor performer
PERFORMANCE ACCOUNTABILITY -> repairs non-performance; can become a political lever
LATERAL ENTRY -> repairs domain deficit; raises representation and memory questions
CONTRACTUAL MISSION-MODE STAFFING -> buys speed; weakens tenure and neutrality guarantees

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 12/12: Answer spine for a civil-services demand

OPEN -> name the function being tested rather than listing duties of the service

BUILD -> the three-trait package, then the legitimacy layer the stem actually engages

CORRECT -> pair every reform with the risk it buys and the protection that reconciles it

CLOSE -> graded verdict, outcome indicators instead of dashboard totals, stated ownership

EVIDENCE LIMIT: AUTHORITY / IMPLEMENTATION: Use the National Programme for Civil Services...